



Go-live setup guide

GitHub Pages · Firebase · GoDaddy · Relay

Everything to take HomeStore POS from the deployment package to app.homestorepos.com, with the public store sign-in ready to link from your website.

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Before you start

You'll set up three things. Each is free to begin with, and each takes about ten to twenty minutes. Do them in order — the app needs the database, and the domain needs the app.

Piece	What it does	Where	Cost
App	index.html + config.js from the package	GitHub Pages at app.homestorepos.com	Free
Database	Firebase Firestore — shares data across every register and dealer	Google Firebase	Free tier, then pay-as-you-go
Relay (optional)	Vendor APIs, live stock & forecasts, POs by API, card terminals, address lookup	Render.com (free web service)	Free tier

You will need: the deployment zip (HomeStorePOS-deploy.zip), your GoDaddy login, a Google account for Firebase, and a GitHub account (free, github.com).

Unzip the package. Inside: index.html (the app), config.js (settings you'll fill in), CNAME, .nojekyll, firestore.rules, README.md, and a relay/ folder for later.

Step 1 — Firebase: the database (≈10 min)

1. Go to console.firebase.google.com → Add project → name it homestore-pos → Continue (Google Analytics is optional) → Create.
2. Left menu Build → Firestore Database → Create database → choose Production mode → location nam5 (United States) → Enable.
3. Build → Authentication → Get started → Sign-in method: enable Anonymous (used by store registers) and Email/Password (used by you).
4. Still in Authentication → Users → Add user: your owner email and a strong password. This is what the administration console will ask for.
5. Back in Firestore Database → Rules tab: delete what's there, paste the entire contents of firestore.rules from the package → Publish.
6. Build → Storage → Get started → Production mode → same region → Done. Rules tab → paste storage.rules → Publish. Delivery photos, damage photos, signatures and ID photos are kept here as files, not in the database.
7. Project settings (gear icon) → General → Your apps → Web (</>) → nickname HomeStore POS → Register app. Copy the six values shown (apiKey, authDomain, projectId, storageBucket, messagingSenderId, appId).
8. Open config.js in a text editor (Notepad works) and paste those six values into the firebase block. Save.
9. Authentication → Settings → Authorized domains → Add domain: app.homestorepos.com. While testing, also add YOUR-USERNAME.github.io.

The rules you pasted let registers look up one store code at a time and never list stores; only your owner account can list or edit dealers. Keep it that way.

Step 2 — GitHub Pages: the app (≈10 min)

1. Create a free account at github.com. Top right + → New repository → name homestore-pos → Public → Create repository.
2. Add file → Upload files → drag in index.html, config.js, CNAME, .nojekyll and the two folders signin and admin (not the relay folder) → Commit changes. The two folders give you the clean addresses /signin and /admin.
3. Repository Settings → Pages (left menu) → Source: Deploy from a branch → Branch main, folder / (root) → Save.
4. On the same page under Custom domain type app.homestorepos.com → Save. Leave Enforce HTTPS for later (it appears once DNS is live).
5. Test now at <https://YOUR-USERNAME.github.io/homestore-pos/admin> — you should see the owner sign-in.

Updating the app later: Add file → Upload files → drop the new index.html over the old one → Commit. Every register gets it on its next refresh. config.js stays as it is.

Step 3 — GoDaddy: the domain (≈5 min)

1. Log in to GoDaddy → My Products → next to homestorepos.com click DNS (Manage DNS).
2. Add New Record: Type CNAME · Name app · Value YOUR-USERNAME.github.io · TTL 1 hour → Save.
3. Optional, for the relay later: another CNAME · Name relay · Value = the hostname Render gives you (Step 6).
4. Wait for DNS (usually a few minutes, up to a day). Then GitHub → Settings → Pages → tick Enforce HTTPS.
5. Your marketing site stays at homestorepos.com; the app lives at app.homestorepos.com.

Step 4 — Your addresses

These are the only two links that matter. Put the first on your website; keep the second to yourself.

Who	Address	What they see
Dealers & their staff (public — link from homestorepos.com header/footer)	https://app.homestorepos.com/signin	One field: store code (e.g. NFM01) → that store's own sign-in with its logo, colors and staff. The device remembers the store. A wrong code shows only “No store found with that code.” Nothing on this page mentions the administration console.
You (private)	https://app.homestorepos.com/admin	Owner email & password (Firebase) → your administrator PIN → the console.
Per-dealer link (optional)	https://app.homestorepos.com/#store/NFM01	Same as typing the code — good for a QR code taped to each register.

Repeated wrong codes lock the page for 30 seconds, doubling each time — a script cannot walk the code space, and the database rules never return a list of stores.

Step 5 — First run (≈10 min)

1. Open <https://app.homestorepos.com/admin> → sign in with the owner email/password → Create your administrator login (name + PIN).
2. Dealers → Add dealer: business name, first manager and PIN. The dealer receives a store code (e.g. NFM01). Tick Load sample data only for a demo store.
3. Send the store two things: the public address app.homestorepos.com/signin and their store code. Every register, tablet and phone opens the address once, types the code, and is remembered.
4. In the store: Settings → work through the Getting-started checklist on Home (logo, tax, trucks, staff, items via CSV, payment methods, terms).
5. Software settings in the console: upload your logo if you want a different one, set the tagline, and later the relay URL.

Step 6 — Relay service: vendor APIs & live stock (≈20 min, optional now)

Skip this until you're ready to connect a vendor API or a card terminal. The app runs fully without it.

1. Firebase console → Project settings → Service accounts → Generate new private key → a JSON file downloads. Keep it private.
2. Create a free account at render.com → New → Web Service → connect GitHub → choose a repo containing the relay/ folder (create a second repo `homestore-pos-relay` and upload the folder's files) → Runtime Node → Build npm install → Start npm start → Free instance.
3. Environment tab → add: `ALLOWED_ORIGINS = https://app.homestorepos.com` · `RELAY_TOKEN =` a long random string · `FIREBASE_SERVICE_ACCOUNT =` the JSON file's contents on one line · optionally `GOOGLE_MAPS_KEY`.
4. Deploy. Open <https://...onrender.com/health> — you should see `{"ok":true}`.
5. Render → Settings → Custom domain relay.homestorepos.com, and add the CNAME in GoDaddy (Step 3).
6. In the app: Administration → Software settings → Relay service URL = <https://relay.homestorepos.com>. In `config.js` set `relayUrl` and `relayToken` (same token) → re-upload `config.js` to GitHub.
7. Administration → Vendor integrations → Add: the vendor's base URL, API key, Live stock path (e.g. `/inventory/{sku}`) and the three field names for available qty, next date, on-order. Assign the vendor to dealers. Supplier-order lines at the register now show live stock, and each PO has Check live availability with the vendor.

Checklist

✓	Item
☐	Firebase project created; Firestore in production mode; Anonymous + Email/Password sign-in enabled; owner user added
☐	firestore.rules pasted and published
☐	config.js filled with the six Firebase values
☐	GitHub repo homestore-pos with index.html, config.js, CNAME, .nojekyll; Pages enabled; custom domain set
☐	GoDaddy CNAME app → YOUR-USERNAME.github.io; Enforce HTTPS ticked once live
☐	app.homestorepos.com/admin opens and the owner login works
☐	First dealer created; store opened from app.homestorepos.com/signin with its code
☐	Sign in link on homestorepos.com points to app.homestorepos.com/signin
☐	(Later) Relay deployed; relay URL set in Software settings and config.js

If something doesn't work

Symptom	Fix
"Can't reach the store data" on the app	config.js values wrong or the domain isn't in Firebase Authorized domains. Check both, reload.
Owner sign-in says failed	The user must exist under Firebase → Authentication → Users with Email/Password enabled.
Dealers can't find their store	The code is typed on app.homestorepos.com/#signin exactly as shown in Dealers (letters/numbers, no spaces). Rules must be published.
Custom domain shows a GitHub 404	DNS not propagated yet, or the CNAME file was not uploaded. Wait, then re-save the custom domain in GitHub Pages.
Live stock says "needs the relay"	Relay URL not set in Software settings, or the relay is asleep on the free tier — open /health to wake it.